VIJO JOHN

Product Owner | Process Excellence | Agentic AI | Generative AI | Finance Platforms | BFSI

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PMP | SAFe POPM | Agentic AI and Generative AI Development | CIMA Affiliate (PER in progress)

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Product management leader and Product Owner with more than 19 years of experience across BFSI, finance platforms, fund administration, financial reporting, FP&A, governance, controls, process excellence and operations. Combines experience as a Vice President and Head of Finance with hands-on AI product delivery using LangGraph, RAG, evaluation harnesses, FastAPI, Streamlit, Azure OpenAI, Groq and Llama.

Translates regulated finance workflows into product vision and strategy, business requirements, PRDs, user stories, acceptance criteria, Agentic Operating Procedures, prioritized backlogs, product roadmaps, release plans, control checkpoints and measurable product outcomes.

Experienced across the end-to-end product lifecycle, partnering with CFO, Operations, Audit, Technology, Engineering, Risk, Compliance and senior leadership teams to deliver scalable AI-enabled finance platforms, source-to-pay workflows, reporting automation, NAV exception management, responsible AI governance, user adoption and continuous improvement in regulated enterprises.

CORE SKILLS

- **Product Ownership:** Product vision and strategy, discovery, problem framing, requirements elicitation and analysis, current-state and future-state process mapping, PRDs, user stories, acceptance criteria, backlog ownership, refinement and prioritization, roadmap planning, client feedback, OKRs, KPIs, KRIs, RICE, impact-effort scoring and executive product storytelling.
- **Agile Delivery and Adoption:** Agile and Scrum, Jira, Confluence, backlog grooming, sprint planning, dependency management, test planning, UAT, release readiness, go-to-market support, user enablement, adoption, value realization, product performance measurement and continuous improvement.
- **Process Excellence and Process Mining:** Six Sigma, root-cause analysis, as-is and to-be process mapping, process standardization, QMS implementation, SOP governance, KPI monitoring and continuous improvement. ARIS process mining for workflow analysis and bottleneck identification; Alteryx ETL and Power Query for data preparation, reporting automation and process optimization.
- **Agentic AI Product Management:** Agentic Operating Procedures (AOPs), agent playbooks, SOP conversion, straight-through processing (STP), exception-based management, decision logic, escalation criteria, data inputs and outputs, system touchpoints, LangGraph orchestration, RAG-grounded assistants, human-in-the-loop controls, guardrails, telemetry, audit trails and evaluation harnesses.
- **Generative AI and LLMOps:** Azure OpenAI, OpenAI, Groq, Llama, embeddings, vector search, Qdrant, LLM-as-judge, golden datasets, groundedness checks, hallucination control, prompt and model comparison, Helicone observability, latency, token and cost monitoring, cost-aware model routing, privacy-by-design and responsible AI controls.
- **Finance Platform Domain:** BFSI, capital markets, investment services, fund administration, financial reporting, FP&A narratives, CFO dashboards, accounts payable, procure-to-pay (P2P), source-to-pay, procurement operations, order-to-cash (O2C), record-to-report (R2R), NAV breaks, SOI review, close automation and compliance workflows.
- **Leadership and Governance:** Cross-functional leadership across Engineering, Operations, Risk and Compliance, senior stakeholder management, client-centric delivery, offshore delivery governance, risk and control ownership, audit readiness, ITGC, SOC 1, ISO 27001, CISO experience, process excellence and change management.

SELECTED PRODUCT AND TRANSFORMATION IMPACT

- **AI Finance OS:** Led product vision, target operating model, MVP scope, user journeys, roadmap priorities and working prototype for an autonomous finance operating layer using LangGraph agents across bookkeeping, MIS, invoicing, intercompany, reconciliation and CFO decision dashboards.
- **FP&A Narrative Reporting Copilot:** Framed business requirements, user stories and acceptance criteria for a private copilot that converts variance drivers, performance data and management context into executive-ready commentary for CFO reviews and board discussions. Used Helicone to monitor request latency, prompt and completion token usage, errors and estimated cost, with cost-aware model routing that directs simpler queries to lower-cost models while reserving stronger models for complex financial narratives.

- **BFSI AI Prototypes:** Delivered NAV Break Investigation, NAV Break Voice Co-pilot, SOI Review, Enterprise Ethics Advisor, Timesheet Intelligence and Agentic RAG writing workflows using consistent evaluation and governance patterns.
- **Operational Outcomes:** Delivered measurable product and business outcomes, including USD 200,000 in annualized savings, a 40 percent productivity improvement, an 80 percent reduction in reporting preparation time, month-end close acceleration from business day 10 to business day 8 and MIS delivery two days earlier.
- **Platform Migration:** Migrated more than 60 clients to a new reporting platform, reduced support tickets by 50 percent and improved stakeholder confidence through structured onboarding and issue governance.
- **Governance Record:** Maintained a record of six consecutive years of ITGC and SOC 1 audits with zero material findings, supported by CISO experience, ISO 27001 certification, SOC readiness and control framework design.

AI PRODUCT PORTFOLIO

- **AI Finance OS:** Developed a flagship product using Python, FastAPI, LangGraph and Streamlit: an autonomous finance operating layer with orchestrated agents for bookkeeping, MIS, invoicing, intercompany and reconciliation workflows. Owned product vision, problem framing, target-state journeys, MVP scope, feature priorities, architecture decisions and prototype delivery.
- **NAV Break Investigation Agent:** Built a LangGraph and Qdrant RAG workflow for detection, investigation and reflection, grounded in NAV validation rules and investigation playbooks, with decision logic, exception triggers, escalation criteria, logging, offline evaluation and reviewer confirmation.
- **NAV Break Voice Co-pilot:** Built a real-time voice bot and analyst co-pilot prototype for daily NAV-striking windows, supporting hands-free break review, source-grounded responses, resolution confirmation, guardrails and audit-ready logs.
- **SOI Review Agent:** Built an eight-agent pipeline for Schedule of Investments review under US GAAP ASC 946, covering document extraction, SOI detection, structured data creation, validation, prior-cycle comparison and preventive controls.
- **Enterprise Ethics Advisor:** Built a local multimodal RAG assistant for corporate ethics guidance, combining policy text and diagram retrieval to provide governed AI advisory without external data exposure.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

McLaren Strategic Solutions, Vice President, Head of Finance, Jun 2025 to Present

- Lead finance as a product-focused business owner, defining product vision, roadmap priorities and measurable outcomes for digital finance and Agentic AI workflows across accounts payable, order-to-cash, record-to-report, close, invoicing, reporting, controls and executive dashboards.
- Lead source-to-pay operations across Asia, with accountability for procurement operations, accounts payable and payments supporting multiple countries, legal entities and business lines across the region.
- Lead discovery with finance and operations stakeholders, translating current-state pain points and future-state workflows into business requirements, PRDs, user stories, acceptance criteria, prioritized backlogs, Agentic Operating Procedures, control checkpoints and product success metrics.
- Partner across Sourcing, Technology, Engineering, business units and service providers to manage dependencies, simplify and automate purchase order, invoice and payment processes, and advance the global source-to-pay strategy.
- Own regional risk and control governance, covering service delivery, operating performance, KPIs, KRIs, issue escalation, dependency management, remediation plans, procedures and supporting documentation.
- Lead ISO 27001 implementation and information security governance, coordinating control design, risk assessments, policy compliance, remediation and audit readiness across Finance and Operations.
- Develop financial strategies, plans, forecasts, KPI dashboards and management reports to support roadmap prioritization, capital allocation, investment cases and executive decision-making.
- Lead, develop and engage a geographically dispersed organization, building leadership capability, accountability, succession strength, user enablement and a collaborative product and operations culture.

State Street, Bangalore, Senior AVP, AVP and Senior Manager, Financial Reporting, Jul 2018 to Jun 2025

Growth path: Senior Manager in 2018, Assistant Vice President in 2020, Senior Assistant Vice President in 2023.

- Served as Product Owner for US GAAP financial reporting for Regulated Investment Companies (RICs), using the SaaS-based ArcReporting and Confluence Unity platforms. Elicited and documented business requirements, defined user stories and acceptance criteria, and owned Jira backlog refinement, feature prioritization, stakeholder alignment and delivery planning for reporting enhancements, automation and data integrity.
- Partnered with DFIN product and engineering teams to triage SaaS incidents and manage enhancement requests covering reporting defects, feature improvements and report-style corrections, coordinating tickets, UAT and validation through resolution.

- Led client onboarding and reporting-platform migration for more than 60 clients, coordinating test plans, UAT, release readiness, user enablement and adoption governance; reduced support tickets by 50 percent and improved delivery confidence.
- Built and led multi-tier reporting teams that delivered US GAAP-compliant financial statements, reconciliations, regulatory reporting packs and client-ready outputs on schedule.
- Built Alteryx ETL workflows and data automation for accounting, financial reporting, data-feed processing and ITGC audit evidence, improving data quality, traceability and control readiness.
- Converted client feedback and stakeholder pain points into product requirements for reporting templates, workflow changes, data specifications, data-feed controls, quality checks and exception handling.
- Oversaw ITGC and SOC 1 audits with zero material findings, partnering with Risk and Compliance to reinforce auditability, control design, data quality and model risk management.
- Led post-M&A integration, P&L optimization, process improvement and cross-functional transformation across people, platforms and operating routines.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

HSBC EDPI, Gurgaon, Manager, Business Finance, Dec 2016 to Jul 2018

- Acted as the finance business partner and product stakeholder for global operations, eliciting and analyzing requirements and translating budgeting, forecasting, variance analysis and executive reporting needs into repeatable planning and reporting workflows.
- Owned intercompany charging and recovery, reconciliations, cost-recovery strategies, flash reports, standardized reporting packs and CFO-level financial models.
- Engineered advanced consolidation and reporting tools using Excel and Power Query, incorporating stakeholder feedback and iterative improvement to strengthen data preparation, review cycles, accuracy and turnaround.

Ameriprise India, Gurgaon, Trainer to Group Leader, Financial Reporting and Tax, Oct 2010 to Dec 2016

- Grew from Fund Accounting Trainer to Group Leader across financial reporting and tax, leading production delivery, workflow allocation, quality control, KPI tracking and stakeholder communication.
- Managed fund accounting, NAV support, shareholder reporting, reconciliations, tax deliverables, training, quality assurance and operational governance for regulated investment products.
- Led Quality Management System (QMS) implementation and process-excellence initiatives across financial reporting and tax operations, standardizing procedures, quality controls, performance metrics and continuous-improvement routines.

MetLife, Greater Noida, Senior Associate to Pre Process Trainer, Jun 2007 to Jan 2010

- Handled premium billing and payment allocation for institutional clients in Small Market Billing, supporting group-insurance account servicing.
- Reconciled premium payments against billing records, investigated billing discrepancies and addressed client queries on premiums, payments and account balances.
- Processed policy and member updates to maintain accurate insurance billing records and support ongoing client servicing.
- Progressed to Pre Process Trainer in Oct 2008, delivering new-hire and train-the-trainer programs and monitoring throughput, yield and attrition to improve training effectiveness.

Convergys India Pvt. Ltd., Gurgaon, Associate, Apr 2006 to Jun 2007

- Handled Citibank credit-card accounts and sales, building early-career grounding in customer operations, service delivery, quality discipline and process adherence in global financial services.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

- MBA, Executive Post Graduate Programme in Strategy and Finance, Indian Institute of Management, Kozhikode, 2023.
- Project Management Professional (PMP), valid through July 2029.
- SAFe Product Owner and Product Manager (POPM).
- Agentic AI and Generative AI Development, Boston Institute of Analytics.
- Six Sigma Black Belt, ISO 27001 Implementer, ISO 9001 Implementer, Leader as a Coach.
- CIMA Affiliate | Professional Experience Requirement (PER) in progress.
- Domains: Capital Markets, Fund Administration, Banking, Insurance, IT, US GAAP and Indian Accounting Standards.
- Portfolio: https://vijojohn.github.io/